

VELUSE AGENCY STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE (SOP)
DEPARTMENT: Client Success & Crisis Management
SUBJECT: The "Angry Boat" Customer Turnaround Protocol
PURPOSE: To establish Veluse Agency's elite standard for crisis management when an operational failure occurs. In business, humans make mistakes, and eventually, we will mess up a Med Spa client's ad campaign or deployment 1, 2. When this happens, our objective is not simply to "make it right" but to over-correct the error so aggressively that we transform a furious client into a lifelong Brand Champion 3, 4.

PART 1: THE FALLACY OF THE REFUND

Amateur agencies believe that when they make a massive mistake, a refund is the ultimate fix 5. This is a fatal misunderstanding of human psychology.

A refund to a customer is merely an apology, and an apology is never enough 6. If you commit a transgression in society, such as involuntary manslaughter, saying "sorry" to the family does not balance the scales; the judicial system forces you to pay a penalty by sentencing you to prison 7. In business, if a Med Spa owner feels wronged and you merely refund their money, they are still in a deficit because they wasted their time, energy, and expectations 7, 8.

When customers feel an apology wasn't enough, they act as their own judicial system and punish you 9. They leave blistering one-star reviews, which destroys your reputation and causes massive negative word-of-mouth 5, 9. It is a mathematical reality that it takes 37 magical moments to overcome a single tragic moment 10. Therefore, refunding them does not bring them back to neutral; we must go above and beyond to make it *better* than right 4, 11.

PART 2: THE "ANGRY BOAT" PROTOCOL (STEP-BY-STEP)

When an operational disaster strikes, you must execute the "Angry Boat" framework. This protocol dictates how our executives handle furious Med Spa founders.

Step 1: Claim Absolute Fault Never blame the media buyer, the Meta algorithm, or the client's front desk 2, 12. If you say it is your fault, it means it is under your control, giving you the absolute power to fix it 13. Skip the guilt, skip the shame, and focus entirely on what you will do to make it right 11.

Step 2: Jump in the "Angry Boat" First You must be quicker to the draw at getting angry than the customer 12, 13. Often, customers will cautiously present the issue to see how you respond, trying to contain their own rage 13. You must immediately become the one who gets emotional *for* them 13.

Step 3: Extreme Validation (The Hyperbolic Shift) You must endlessly validate their anger so they feel seen, heard, and felt 14. You cannot minimize someone else's pain; only *they* can minimize it 14. The only way to get a furious Med Spa owner to calm down is to make the transgression a bigger deal to you than it is to them 14, 15.

- **Execution:** "This is completely unacceptable. I am furious that our team let this happen. You have every right to be livid, and I am honestly surprised you aren't trying to put me in jail right now" 13, 15. Because you took the extreme position, the client is psychologically forced to de-escalate and reassure *you*: "Hey, it's not that big of a deal, calm down" 14, 15.

Step 4: The "Better Than Right" Over-Correction Once you have de-escalated the client through validation, you ask the golden question: *"What would it take for me to make this*

right?" 16. You do not stop at a refund. You take the total cost of the refund, add additional resources, and blow their expectations out of the water 2, 5. If you turn a tragic moment into a series of magic moments, they will realize you went so far out of your way that they become a True Believer in your brand 3, 4.

PART 3: APPLICATION SCENARIO (THE BOTCHED AD CAMPAIGN)

The Scenario: A Veluse Agency media buyer optimizes a high-ticket Med Spa campaign incorrectly, targeting 18-to-24-year-olds instead of 35-to-55-year-old affluent women for a \$10,000 laser package 17. The Med Spa owner spends \$3,000 in ad spend over the weekend and receives 40 leads who are functionally broke or completely unqualified 17, 18. The owner calls us, absolutely furious.

The Veluse Turnaround Execution:

- **Do Not Defend the Agency:** Our Account Manager does not explain the complexity of the Meta pixel or say, "We just need time for the algorithm to season." That invalidates the client and guarantees a cancellation 19.
- **The Angry Boat Script:** "John, I was just looking at your ad account, and I am absolutely livid. This targeting mistake is completely unacceptable. Our team messed up, and you just burned \$3,000 dealing with unqualified leads over your weekend. I would be screaming if I were in your shoes." 13, 14.
- **The Over-Correction (The Box of Responsibility):** We empower our frontline Account Managers with a "box of responsibility"—pre-approved financial levers they can pull immediately without asking executive permission 20, 21.
- **The Make-Good:** "John, I am refunding your \$3,000 ad spend out of Veluse Agency's pocket immediately 22. A refund isn't enough to make up for the time your front desk wasted calling those leads, so I am also waiving your entire \$5,000 retainer for next month. Furthermore, our Senior Media Director is personally taking over your account today to rebuild this targeting from scratch."
- **The Result:** The client feels incredibly validated and sees that we hold ourselves to militant standards. By taking the financial loss upfront and over-correcting, we prevent the client from cancelling, eliminate negative word-of-mouth, and secure a highly loyal partner who will likely stay with Veluse for years 4, 23, 24.